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United States Department of State

Washington, D. C. 20520

October 14, 1986

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INFORMATION MEMORANDUM

S/S *KG 10/14*

TO: The Secretary

FROM: EUR - Rozanne L. Ridgway *MR*

SUBJECT: Gorbachev Reports to the Soviet People on Reykjavik

In an hour-long address on Soviet TV, Gorbachev called the Iceland meeting an important event that had created a qualitatively new situation. He stressed that the work that went into the meeting would not be in vain (indeed, he emphasized that the Soviet proposals were the result of "broad" discussions involving the Soviet military, other agencies, and Soviet allies) and that new efforts were needed to build better relations. Expressing his hope that the President better understood Soviet positions and intentions, he said that the U.S. will need time to consider the Soviet proposals and acknowledged that such issues cannot be resolved in one stroke.

Although these comments strongly imply that the Soviet "package" remains on the table, Gorbachev did not directly say so. Neither did he refer to the possibility of another summit. In contrast to his press conference following the meeting, he also left out specific mention of the Soviet agreement to reduce Asian SS-20s to 100.

Despite Gorbachev's upbeat assessment of future dialogue, his bottom line was that progress depended on the U.S. giving up the "chimera" of SDI. He said that since Reykjavik, SDI is even more a "sore-spot" in everyone's eyes. Gorbachev had largely ignored the testing issue during his press conference in Iceland; now, however, he charged that the U.S. wanted to defer the deadline for a test ban "for decades" and described continued U.S. nuclear testing, together with SDI, as the two main unresolved issues.

Gorbachev said that a Politburo meeting today had discussed the results of the meeting and that a report of the Soviet leadership's assessment would appear tomorrow.

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REVIEWED by *KG*

Date: *11/4/87*

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A vertical strip of 15 frames showing a sequence of dot patterns that form the letters 'A', 'B', 'C', 'D', 'E', 'F', 'G', 'H', 'I', 'J', 'K', 'L', 'M', 'N', and 'O'. Each frame contains a grid of dots, with some dots being black and others white, to create the shape of each letter.

Classified: EUR:TS/monof
EUR/sov:MParrif